

SHEKHAR DASH

Chapel Hill, NC | dshekh@unc.edu | +1(919) 951-8138 | shekhar@hateylekha.com | [Portfolio](#)

EDUCATION

University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill, Chapel Hill, NC, USA 2026

Master of Arts, Educational Innovation, Technology & Entrepreneurship (MEITE)

Specialization: Adaptive Learning Analytics

Satyajit Ray Film & Television Institute, Kolkata, India 2016–2019

Postgraduate Diploma in Cinema — Direction & Screenplay Writing (3-Year PG)

Fully funded ICCR Scholarship, Government of India

Visva Bharati University (Founded by Tagore), Santiniketan, India 2009–2012

B.Mus (Hons), Drama and Theatre Arts

HONORS AND AWARDS

Professional Fellowship in Entrepreneurship, U.S. Department of State — Global Leaders Division 2025

Economic Empowerment: Emerging Leaders from South Asia; hosted by the University of Oklahoma's Gaylord College of Journalism

ICCR Scholarship (Fully Funded), Indian Council for Cultural Relations, Government of India 2016

Awarded to pursue postgraduate studies at Satyajit Ray Film & Television Institute, Kolkata

Gold Medal, Secondary School Certificate (SSC), Sonali Bank PLC, Bangladesh 2004

GPA 5.0 (Golden A+); ranked among approximately 3,000 of nearly 1 million national examinees

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Mathematics Potential Lab (MPL) — UNC Chapel Hill 2025–Present

Research Assistant — Supervisor: Dr. Jessica Rodrigues

Project KEY (NSF CAREER Award #2237053, 2023–2028):

- Contribute to systematic journal analysis examining how mathematics-focused research is communicated to K–12 practitioners, with emphasis on students with disabilities and general education learners.
- Support design and evaluation of key abstracts — infographic-style research translation tools aimed at closing the persistent research-to-practice gap in mathematics education.
- Co-authoring an empirical research paper with Dr. Jessica Rodrigues on research dissemination and practitioner uptake in math education.

POD — Special Education Faculty Jobs Paired Open Database:

- Serve as data visualizer for a multi-year project tracking and analyzing higher education faculty job postings across U.S. higher education institutions.
- Design data visualizations supporting both practitioner outreach and research reporting on national demand for special education faculty.

"From Instruction to Interaction" — Graduate Research Project, MEITE Program, UNC Chapel Hill 2025–Present

Graduate Researcher

- Lead an ongoing design-based research project exploring how AI- and XR-mediated embodied interactions can transform pedagogical practice, integrating learning analytics and interaction analysis.
- Presented poster at SITE 2025 International Conference: "From Instruction to Interaction: Designing an Embodied, AI-Supported Learning Ecology."

Montana App — Attention & Storytelling in Digital Learning, UNC Chapel Hill 2025–Present

Researcher & Learning Experience Designer — in collaboration with Dr. Todd Cherner

- Designed and prototyped an educational app that detects learner mind-wandering and delivers story-driven re-engagement interventions, grounded in cognitive science.
- Planning empirical study with Dr. Todd Cherner investigating how storytelling functions as an attention-retrieval mechanism in digital learning environments.

LEARNING EXPERIENCE & INSTRUCTIONAL DESIGN

VER Coaching — VR Athlete Performance Lab, Chapel Hill, NC 2025–2026

Data Analysis & Media Production Intern

- Analyzed VR-generated athlete performance data and designed visualizations communicating actionable training insights to coaching staff.
- Produced video content across multiple formats to support audience development and establish the startup's identity.

Marc Cuban Foundation — GenAI Evaluation Tool, UNC Chapel Hill 2026

Instructional Designer & Prototype Developer

- Co-designed LLM Math Sec, an assessment instrument enabling K–12 educators to critically evaluate generative AI tools for mathematics lesson planning.
- Built interactive prototype using Figma; conducted user testing and surveys via Qualtrics, and presented findings and recommendations to foundation stakeholders.

Intuition — Analytical Thinking App, UNC Chapel Hill 2025–Present

Learning Experience Designer

- Designing an educational app aimed at developing learners' analytical thinking capacities through structured, scaffolded interaction sequences grounded in cognitive learning theory.

Geometry 360° Virtual Tour — Peabody Hall, UNC, UNC Chapel Hill 2025

Learning Experience Designer

- Produced an immersive 360° educational video situating geometry concepts (Pythagorean theorem, parallel lines, similar triangles) within real architectural spaces for grades 6–10 learners.
- Designed to make abstract mathematical ideas spatially and experientially accessible.

CodeCracker — Educational Game, Cosmic Soup Ltd., Dhaka 2024

Game Designer & Project Lead

- Designed and led the team in developing an educational game on C programming fundamentals; engaged by 2,000+ high school students in Bangladesh.
- Shortlisted for the ICT Idea Grant by the Ministry of ICT, Bangladesh.

Ministry of Education, Bangladesh — Remote Learning Initiative, Dhaka 2023

Project Lead & Creative Director (contracted via Dreamer Donkey Ltd.)

- Led production of hundreds of curriculum-aligned educational video lessons for elementary and middle school learners across Bangladesh, coordinating educators, videographers, animators, voice artists, video editors, and gfx designers.
- Collaborated with government officials and subject-matter experts to translate national curriculum standards into engaging, evidence-based distance learning media.

Hatey Lekha — Youth Arts & Media Initiative, Dhaka 2024–Present

Founder & Cultural Initiative Lead

- Founded an arts and culture initiative integrating audiovisual production, music, and publication into community-based programs for underserved youth.
- Under Hatey Lekha, launched Payntara — a youth-focused micro-OTT platform — providing hands-on filmmaking, storytelling, and media production workshops to young creators, connecting participants with professional tools and mentorship.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Bangladesh Cinema and Television Institute (BCTI), Dhaka 2023–2025

Senior Instructor — Graduate Level

- Designed and delivered graduate-level courses in World Film History I & II and Advanced Screenplay Writing for cohorts of emerging filmmakers.
- Mentored student film productions from concept through final cut; provided structured feedback on narrative, direction, and post-production craft.
- Contributed to curriculum redesign as a member of the Syllabus Review Committee (2024–25).

Jagannath University, Department of Film & Television, Dhaka 2022–2025

Adjunct Faculty — Undergraduate & Graduate Level

- Taught six courses spanning film history, direction, screenplay writing, music video production, and literary adaptation.

- Developed course materials, designed assessment rubrics, and guided practical productions from pre-production through final delivery.

ENTREPRENEURSHIP

Cosmic Soup Ltd., Dhaka 2023–Present

Founder & Managing Director

- Lead strategic planning, product development, and business growth for a startup operating at the intersection of gaming, SaaS, and educational technology.
- Developed Rushpath, an edtech game platform shortlisted for the ICT Idea Grant (Ministry of ICT, Bangladesh), and Kancha, an agro-market platform connecting smallholder farmers with retailers.

GEONICS, Dhaka 2013–2022

Founder & Head of Creatives

- Founded and led a media production company delivering TVCs, documentaries, and television productions for corporate and government clients across nearly a decade.
- Managed end-to-end production: talent acquisition, client relations, creative direction, and quality assurance.

CREATIVE & INDEPENDENT MEDIA WORK (SELECTED)

Narrative & Fiction

Badhonhara — Feature Film, Black Mirror Films, Dhaka 2024–Present

Screenplay Writer — Pre-Production

- Wrote the screenplay for a biographical feature film on legendary Bengali poets Kazi Nazrul Islam and Jibananda Das.

bokjon hokjhok — Feature Film, Black Mirror Films, Dhaka 2024–Present

Screenplay Writer & Director

- Writing and directing this feature film, overseeing narrative development, visual design, and production coordination.

Khoka — Animation Series, Mars Solutions Ltd., Dhaka 2023–2024

Screenplay Writer & Creative Producer

- Developed the screenplay and co-led production of this animation series, shaping visual and audio design throughout.

'Who Killed the Father' — Docu-Fiction, Dhaka 2024–2025

Director

- Oversaw narrative structure, production coordination, and editorial direction for a docu-fiction on Sheikh Mujibur Rahman, the founding father of Bangladesh.

Bildakini — Feature Film, Data Solutions, Dhaka 2021–2023

Screenplay Writer & Creative Producer

- Developed the screenplay and co-led production of this national film grant-winning feature film, shaping visual and audio design throughout.

Laal Moroger Jhuti — Feature Film, Pandulipi Karkhana, Dhaka 2021–2022

Post-Production Supervisor — National Award-Winning Film

- Oversaw editing, sound design, color grading, and DCP output, ensuring creative consistency and technical excellence throughout post-production.

Commissioned & Documentary Work

ATC Day — Docu-Fiction, Bangladesh Civil Aviation Authority 2024

Director & Producer

- Directed and produced a commissioned docu-fiction for the official Air Traffic Control Day celebration of the Bangladesh Civil Aviation Authority.

Health Awareness Video Series (8 Episodes), Ministry of Health, Bangladesh 2022–2023

Producer & Screenplay Writer

- Produced eight public health awareness videos commissioned by the Bangladesh Ministry of Health for national broadcast and community outreach.

Promotional Film — Dubai International Trade Summit, Teletalk Bangladesh 2022–2023

Director & Producer

- Directed a promotional film commissioned by Teletalk Bangladesh (state-owned telecom) for representation at the Dubai International Trade Summit.

TVC — Puriva Rice Bran Oil, Dhaka 2018–2019

Director

- Directed a television commercial for Puriva Rice Bran Oil, managing full production from concept through broadcast delivery.

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

Dash, S. (2025). From Instruction to Interaction: Designing an Embodied, AI-Supported Learning Ecology. Poster session and proceedings paper presented at the Society for Information Technology & Teacher Education (SITE) International Conference 2026.

PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT & CERTIFICATIONS

Articulate Storyline Essential Training | Introduction to Virtual Reality (Coursera / Goldsmiths, University of London) | AI for Business Analysis | Statistics Foundations | Project Management Foundations | Negotiation Foundations | Film Appreciation Course (Film and Television Institute of India, Pune) | CITI Research Ethics Training

SKILLS

eLearning & Authoring Tools: Articulate 360 (Storyline & Rise), Figma, Adobe Animate, Adobe Premiere Pro, Adobe Photoshop, Final Draft

Immersive Media & XR: 360-Video Production, AR/VR Prototyping, XR Learning Environment Design

Data Analysis & Visualization: R, Python, Flourish, Qualtrics

Film & Media Production: Screenwriting, Film Direction, Post-Production Supervision, Sound Design, Cinematography, Studio Infrastructure Design

Leadership & Management: Project Management, Stakeholder Communication, Strategic Planning, Cross-functional Team Coordination, Startup Operations

Languages: Bengali (Native), English (Fluent — C1)

PROFESSIONAL MEMBERSHIPS

Screenwriters Association (SWA), Mumbai, India — Member since 2019

Bangladesh Short Film Forum (BSFF), Dhaka — Member since 2021